

COW

Bitilasana

Mimicking the slightly dipped back of a cow, this gentle kneeling pose incorporates a backbend, and is practiced to warm up the spine, hips, and shoulders. Inhale as you enter the pose; you can also alternate between this and Cat pose, in time with your breath.

THE BIG PICTURE

Your abdominal and chest muscles stretch, while your back muscles—including your spinal extensors—engage. Your rib cage is expanding, making it possible to inhale fully. A subtle, even curve is created by the backbend and raised head.

ALIGNMENT

Your arms and thighs are fixed in place with your knees under your hips and hands under your shoulders (or slightly forward). Your backbend is as even as possible, focusing on lengthening your neck, creating a subtle, even curve.

